HybridGuard: Cross-Layer Fingerprint Consistency for Android Web Environments

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Abstract

Web services use browser-visible environment reports to recognize clients and inform security decisions, yet reports can be modified without corresponding device changes. In Android hybrid Web applications, Native, WebView Host, and App Web provide complementary observations of the same environment. Their semantic relationships offer potential integrity evidence: an individually plausible Web report may be incompatible with its system or container context.

HybridGuard associates observations from the same hybrid Web execution and checks their semantic compatibility, accounting for unavailable evidence and legitimate cross-API differences. We collect these observations and use controlled fingerprint manipulations and separate fixed-check comparisons to examine the effectiveness and limits of cross-layer references.

Across 14 controlled manipulation configurations, HybridGuard's App detector detects 105/126 effective modifications (83.3%), with no alarms on 252 controlled normal records. A Native memory reference detects 18/18 modifications versus 6/18 for a global Web-only threshold, both with 0/48 normal alarms, showing the additional information supplied by device-specific context. A Native timezone reference and an absolute Web condition each detect 6/6 modifications, with 0/30 and 6/30 normal alarms, respectively; those six alarms arise from legitimate system timezone changes. In a separate WebView-host geometry study, a host reference and a fixed Web-height threshold each detect 6/6 modifications, with 0/66 and 6/66 normal alarms, respectively; the threshold flags legitimate layout changes. These findings support cross-layer consistency as useful integrity evidence when an observable, semantically related reference remains informative beyond the manipulated report. Neither Native nor Host is a root of trust, and consistency neither proves authenticity nor guarantees detection of coordinated cross-surface manipulation.

CCS Concepts

• **Security and privacy → Web application security**; *Intrusion/anomaly detection and malware mitigation.*

Keywords

browser fingerprinting, Android WebView, cross-layer consistency, manipulation detection, missing evidence

1 Introduction

Web services use browser-visible environment reports to recognize clients and inform security-related decisions, including authentication [1, 6, 8]. A party controlling the reporting surface can alter these reports without changing the underlying device. Fingerprint spoofing and inconsistent evasive reports are established concerns [7, 10, 11]. Their integrity therefore matters to these security decisions.

In Android hybrid Web applications, Native observations describe system and hardware properties; the WebView Host supplies container, configuration, and layout context; and App Web exposes JavaScript-visible reports. These partially overlapping observations concern the same running environment, with complementary meanings [2]. A Web value that appears reasonable in isolation may be incompatible with its system or container context. We ask: *When can cross-layer semantic consistency serve as integrity evidence for Web-visible environment reports?*

Web-reported memory can remain below a global threshold yet exceed what the device plausibly supports; a Native reference supplies device context. A normal system timezone change can preserve compatible observations, whereas changing only the Web report may break their relationship. Normal container-layout changes can affect Web geometry; host context helps interpret whether a reported size remains compatible with its container. These interpretations depend on measurement semantics, legitimate setting changes, and available evidence.

HybridGuard associates observations from the same hybrid Web execution and evaluates semantic relations with explicit applicability conditions. Unavailable or insufficient evidence remains distinct from an observed violation or a definite no-alert result. Detection conditions are combined under constraints on normal alarms and definite-output coverage. Controlled fingerprint manipulations provide the experimental setting: they reveal when local report changes leave contradictions and how normal environmental changes affect the same relations.

The App detector, which combines within-view and cross-view checks, detects 105/126 effective modifications (83.3%) across 14 controlled configurations, with no alarms on 252 controlled normal records. Separate comparisons of fixed checks explain the value of references: a Native memory reference detects 18/18 modifications versus 6/18 for a Web-only threshold, and the Native timezone reference distinguishes tested system changes from local report modifications. A separate host-geometry study distinguishes tested layout changes from report modifications using a container reference; this check is not integrated into the App detector. These comparisons suggest that cross-layer references are useful when they remain observable and semantically informative beyond the locally modified Web report.

Historical normal records expose alarm costs and inconclusive outcomes that controlled normal records alone do not reveal. An external-browser extension examines an additional observation surface. The controlled materials have development-use history; the study does not provide an independent test of attack generalization on real devices. Misses can also reflect limited candidate representations or evidence coverage.

Our contributions are:

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- A formulation and implemented framework for assessing report integrity through semantic relationships among complementary observations from the same hybrid Web execution.
- Experimental evidence showing how Native references add device context and distinguish local manipulation from normal changes, complemented by a standalone study of Host geometry.
- A characterization of detection capability, normal alarms, and unavailable evidence that identifies applicability conditions and costs.

HybridGuard offers integrity evidence without treating Native or Host as a root of trust; a no-alert result does not establish safety, and coordinated changes across compared surfaces may evade its checks.

2 Cross-Layer Integrity in Hybrid Web Environments

2.1 Multiple Views of One Execution

An Android hybrid Web execution provides three complementary, partially overlapping views. Native supplies system and hardware observations; the WebView Host supplies container, configuration, provider, and layout context; App Web exposes JavaScript-visible reports inside that WebView [2]. Let E denote the relevant runtime state and container context, beyond a static device model or identifier. We write these observations as $N(E)$, $H(E)$, and $W(E)$ without assuming noiseless, complete, or deterministic API outputs. Associating observations from one execution supports comparison, without implying atomic sampling, trusted collection, or hardware attestation.

The implemented App177 measurement contract catalogs 84 Native, 26 Host, and 67 App Web fields. An external browser runs a separate Web execution on the same device. Browser67 catalogs 67 fields from that execution; paired244 represents linked App–browser observations. These counts describe implementation catalogs, not independent information or the inputs used by every detector.

2.2 Cross-Layer Consistency as Integrity Evidence

Integrity here concerns report manipulation; available evidence limits which relations can be assessed. A local Web-report modification can be illustrated as

$$x_E = (N(E), H(E), W(E)),$$
$$x'_E = (N(E), H(E), W'(E)).$$

Each semantic relation C_j constrains a relevant subset of observations, such as Native–Web or Host–Web. Its interpretation requires an applicability domain, usable operands, and the necessary measurement context. A difference provides evidence only insofar as it violates that measurement constraint.

Local editing may break an applicable relation when other observations still provide distinguishing context: a plausible Web value can then be incompatible with its reference. Some edits remain within compatible ranges. A normal system timezone change may instead move observations together while preserving their relation. Sampling times and implementation differences still limit this interpretation. More views alone do not guarantee a gain; useful evidence depends on informative references and interpretable constraints. This is a mechanism examined empirically, not a necessary-and-sufficient characterization.

HybridGuard evaluates concrete checks using their current required observations. E is explanatory, not an available ground-truth label: the detector neither reconstructs E nor proves that all observations describe a single authentic environment. The notation does not imply access to pre-change baselines, recovery records, or experiment-stage labels. C_j describes compatibility, whereas $r_j(x)$ in Section 3 denotes a detection condition's state.

The three-view model does not require every relation to use all views or imply a triangle of validated checks. Full App combines within-view and cross-view checks; Host geometry remains a separate, unintegrated study; no standalone Native–Host detection rule has been validated.

2.3 Adversary and Scope of Integrity Claims

The tested manipulations alter selected resource, browser, locale, display, and graphics reports through controlled tools, browser emulation, or runtime overrides, without necessarily changing the physical device. Only a measured effect at the target surface qualifies as an *effective modification*; operations with no observable effect remain separate.

Native and Host can also be manipulated. A reference left unchanged by a tested intervention is neither a trusted root nor evidence of statistical or administrative independence. Coordinated changes across compared views, collector control, or backend compromise may evade checks; resistance to these capabilities is unproven. Such evasion differs from misses caused by limited implemented relations or observation coverage.

An alarm means an applicable integrity-check condition triggered; it does not confirm fraud, account takeover, malicious intent, or attacker identity. No alert does not establish authenticity. Evaluation units are saved *record positions* or applicable paired positions; repeated operations are not independent devices. Experiment roles and operation records serve evaluation, not prediction.

2.4 Normal Variation and Missing Evidence

Normal system timezone, language, orientation, and application-layout changes affect comparability, as do API precision, units, support, and container state. Semantic relations can account for unit conversion, coarse reporting, measurement intervals, and container applicability. Legitimate differences require interpretation within these constraints; they are not automatically violations or unknown outcomes.

Observation availability, a relation among observations, and the detector's final output are distinct. For a selected condition, T marks a triggered alarm condition; F means it does not trigger, without certifying authenticity; U means required evidence is unavailable or insufficient, or the relation is inapplicable. Execution or association failure is recorded separately as FAILED. An empty model also has a separate status, not an ordinary normal result.

A missing required operand can prevent judging its relation. An unused field's absence does not independently fail the detector,

and a check using only some views does not require all three to be complete. Missing evidence is not filled in as normal. Section 3 explains how HybridGuard implements these conditional relations and evidence states as executable checks and detectors.

3 HybridGuard

HybridGuard implements the conditional relations of Section 2 as executable checks on associated observations. It preserves evidence states and constructs detectors under normal-alarm and coverage constraints; frozen App and App–browser models then evaluate current inputs. Figure 1 separates collection, semantic checking, and offline construction.

3.1 Provenance-Bound Observation Collection

Comparison requires associating values with the execution and collection context they describe. Under the contracts in Section 2, Native, Host, and App Web observations retain values and field states. Original records, receipts, and association metadata support source tracing and validity checks; they provide neither authenticated measurements nor atomic sampling.

Current collection intervals and stability information support applicable checks. In the geometry study, Host-before/after observations surround the Web snapshot within one collection; they are not attack-before and recovery-after records. Operation labels, experimental phases, and other pre-intervention or restoration records do not enter a current prediction.

An external browser remains a separate execution context. Valid linkage forms paired observations; incomplete Browser collection preserves App-only data without inventing a Browser vector.

3.2 State-Aware Semantic Consistency

An executable check combines operands, source and validity requirements, measurement interpretation, applicability conditions, and a trigger. Units, coarse reporting, and time context are handled according to the relevant API semantics. For a relation-conflict check, usable and applicable evidence violating C_j triggers $r_j(x)$. The pool also contains single-field conditions, within-view relations, and admitted polarities; these are not all negations of C_j.

For current observation x, $r_j(x) \in \{\mathsf{T}, \mathsf{F}, \mathsf{U}, \mathsf{FAILED}\}$. An empty selected set has its own status. Otherwise, the detector validates inputs required by selected checks: relevant execution or association failures yield FAILED before considering triggers. Without such failure, any T yields an alert; a nonempty set of all F yields definite no-alert; remaining unresolved cases yield U. Thus T can coexist with another condition's U, but cannot override FAILED. Ordinary missing or inapplicable operands remain U, not F; unselected-field problems do not independently fail the detector.

3.3 Cross-Layer Integrity Relations

Native–Web memory. Native memory supplies device context through an upper envelope on the Web report. Both operands must be observed, finite, positive GiB values from the same bound App record, with $m_{\text{native}} \geq 0.25$. On these valid, applicable inputs, the trigger is

$$r_{\text{mem}}(x) = \mathsf{T} \iff m_{\text{web}} > 2^{\lceil \log_2 m_{\text{native}} \rceil}. \tag{1}$$

The power-of-two envelope accommodates coarse reporting and permits lower Web exposures. It detects upward violations of this envelope; downward, within-envelope, or coordinated reports may remain compatible. Unusable measured operands yield U; binding failures retain FAILED. The fixed Web-only comparator is $m_{\text{web}} > 8$ GiB.

Native–Web timezone. The Native IANA zone supplies context for interpreting a Web offset. For time-dependent zones, the current device collection interval and fixed timezone database 2026c determine the effective UTC offset. The check compares its negative with Web `getTimezoneOffset`, using UTC-minus-local minutes. Supported fixed-offset IDs can be evaluated without a date when consistent with the observed Native standard offset. The comparison concerns effective offsets, allowing different names with the same offset.

Missing reliable intervals for time-dependent zones, ambiguous transition intervals, or unusable measurement evidence yield U; zero and minus one are valid values. Database or association failures follow the FAILED policy. A normal system-zone change can remain compatible when the measured offsets move together, while a local Web override can violate the relation. Collection timing and applicability still bound this interpretation.

Host–Web geometry. The containing View supplies geometric context outside the webpage's own measurements. For either axis, P is the CSS visual-viewport size multiplied by device-pixel ratio and viewport scale; the local scalar H_{view} is the Host View size minus its own padding. The check triggers if either axis satisfies

$$P > H_{\text{view}} + \epsilon,$$
$$\epsilon = 2 + 4 \cdot 2^{-23} \max(|P|, |H_{\text{view}}|, 1) \quad \text{pixels}.$$

Snapshot binding and Host stability before and after that Web snapshot are prerequisites. Stability is assessed independently of Host–Web agreement, preserving stable contradictions as evidence. Valid dimensions, pixel ratio, and scale must be finite and positive. The implemented domain requires an attached, visible View, zero padding, and an identity View transform; outside-domain measurements yield U, while binding failures yield FAILED. The tolerance is an engineering choice, not a platform guarantee. This specialist check remains separate from Full App and its candidate pool.

3.4 Constrained Detector Construction

Checks need detection information, normal-data availability, and bounded alarm and inconclusive-output costs. Maximizing controlled detections alone does not enforce these requirements. The App pool comprises 50 base templates and three fixed relations: Native memory, Native timezone, and same-Web viewport. Training-side numeric encoding and threshold expansion produce 65/65/56 atoms before admission, which considers admissible polarities. Historical evaluation records do not supply thresholds; their prior use in development is disclosed.

For selected singleton-OR clauses S, the sparse stage uses

$$J(S) = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{k=1}^{K} \bar{d}_k(S) - 0.005\, C(S), \tag{2}$$

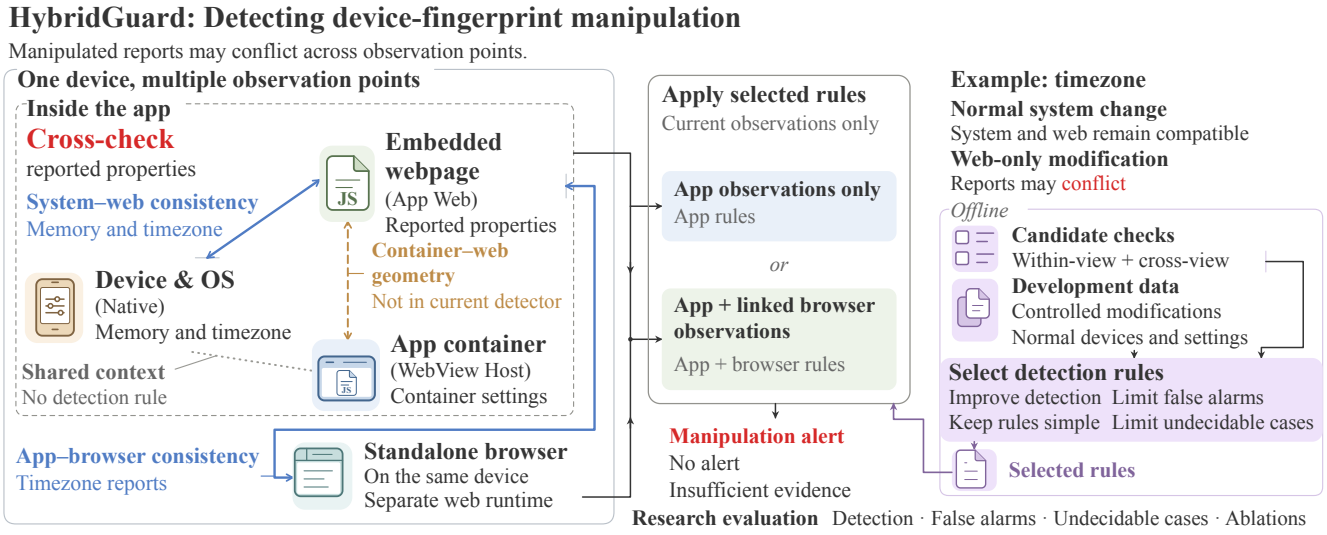


Figure 1: HybridGuard connects current observations to semantic checks. Offline construction constrains normal alarms and definite-output coverage; frozen models support App-only and linked App–browser evaluation. Solid comparison edges identify evaluated relations. Host–Web geometry is a separate study; the dotted Native–Host edge supplies context only. No surface is trusted ground truth. No alert does not establish safety, and execution failures are recorded separately.

where $K = 14$. Each $\bar{d}_k$ averages whole-detector detections over effective positions within each training environment, then equally across environments. Complexity $C(S)$ counts clauses plus literal occurrences, distinct from compatibility relations C_j. Greedy improving additions, the best feasible prefix, and backward pruning constitute a heuristic without global-optimality guarantees.

Constraints allow at most eight singleton OR clauses, complexity 16, two conditions per registered family, and no opposite polarities of one atom. Controlled and historical training-normal alarm budgets are 8/168 and 31/630. Historical-normal candidate assessability and final definite-output coverage must each reach 90%; controlled coverage must reach 80% per phase. Fits disallow execution failures and have a 60-second deadline. Appendix A details training-side admission.

Retention starts from each configuration's own sparse solution and preserves existing training detections. Additions increase semantic coverage; same-group swaps use registered higher-quality alternatives and additionally forbid new controlled-normal alarms or losses of definite controlled outputs. All proposals remain feasible. Retention does not continue optimizing Equation 2. Evaluation uses fixed saved retention models, without selecting stages or configurations per result cell.

3.5 Additional Observation Surface: External Browser

The extension tests whether a separate Web execution adds evidence beyond App observations. It is an optional evaluation mode, not a sequential fallback. The retained model combines the frozen App detector with C1, which triggers on unequal, validly linked App Web and Browser offsets using the same Web sign convention.

Both operands require observed status, observed-value quality, and finite numeric, non-Boolean values; zero and minus one are valid. Unavailable or inapplicable operands yield U; association failures retain FAILED precedence. C1 has no timestamp gate and does not inherit Native timezone interval handling, leaving asynchronous normal setting changes unresolved.

Construction enumerates no addition, C1, language condition C2, and C1+C2 on the frozen App base. Normal-alarm budgets are 31/630, 0/12, and 1/34 for historical training, pilot, and matched normals, respectively, with 90% definite outputs per normal group and 90% historical candidate assessability. C2 alarms on two matched normal preference changes; C1+C2 also has only 566/630 definite historical training outputs. Neither satisfies the constraints. This selects an increment without retraining a joint classifier over all fields. Original App-benchmark positions lack contemporaneous Browser counterparts, so paired evaluation remains separate.

4 Evaluation

We ask four questions: which modifications are detected and which components matter (RQ1); what cost is hidden by controlled-normal results (RQ2); how contextual references change individual checks (RQ3); and where an external browser adds capability (RQ4).

4.1 Materials and Protocol

Controlled App benchmark. The benchmark contains 378 positions: 14 modification configurations, three repetitions, three Android emulator environments (API 29, 30, and 36 with SwiftShader), and three stages per run. Admitted runs contain a normal pre-position, an effective modification, and a confirmed normal post-position. This gives 126 effective modifications and 252 normal records. The normal post-position is an evaluation/control record,

not an input available to an earlier prediction. Three leave-one-environment-out configurations each use 252 training positions (84 modified, 168 normal) and 126 held-out positions (42 modified, 84 normal). We aggregate the disjoint held-out positions once. Development exposure to these environments and recipes means this partition is not evidence of unseen-tool or independent physical-device generalization.

Historical normal records. The mobile test-cloud (MTC) material comprises 891 representative records: 630 discovery records for constraints and tree training, 144 historical development records, and 117 historically reserved evaluation records. Representatives are manufacturer/model/Android-release combinations, not 891 independent physical devices; model families and known installation/session associations constrain grouping. The last two sets are reported separately. Each frozen model is applied to the same records; three model outputs do not triple the sample size. "Normal" means no study-defined target manipulation, not an attestation that a cloud device has no automation or debugging software.

Specialist and paired material. The memory study has 18 effective modifications and 48 normal records, plus six operations with no observable effect. The timezone study has six modifications and 30 normal records; six normal system changes are a subset of the 30. The screen study has six modifications and 66 normal records, including six normal layout expansions. The App–browser language/timezone material contains 60 paired positions: 14 effective modifications and 46 normal records, from an 18-position pilot and a 42-position matched batch. Normal records total 12 + 34, not just the matched subset. These materials have development-use history and distinct roles. We do not add their denominators to produce an overall accuracy or an independent population sample.

Methods. Full App denotes the saved App retention detector. Four ablations are retrained from their own sparse stage: remove the MTC alarm cap, use App-Web-only candidates, remove the memory reference, or remove the timezone reference. Removing the MTC cap raises its allowance to 630, while retaining MTC data, assessability and coverage constraints, and the controlled-normal budget. Web-only removes Native dependencies, so it changes available information as well as the relationships. The host-geometry specialist and Browser C1 are outside this pool.

The App tree uses the same fold-specific admitted candidate representation, with separate true/false/unknown indicators, maximum depth three, minimum leaf size two, Gini splitting, and a fixed random seed. Training weight is one half for effective modifications, one quarter for controlled normals, and one quarter for MTC normals; modification weight is balanced across configurations. This is a fixed small-capacity reference, not the performance ceiling of machine learning or a classifier over all raw App fields. Rule rows use the saved `RETENTION` stage and tree rows the saved `FITTED` stage.

Measures and reporting. A detection is an alert on an effective modification; a normal alarm is an alert on a normal record. We retain no-alert, unknown, failed, and empty-model counts. Unknown records stay in denominators rather than being counted as benign. Percentages are descriptive ratios for the stated cohort; we do not estimate population recall, claim significance from repeated configurations, or invent confidence intervals from dependent positions. The tables transcribe frozen results; assembling this draft involved no new collection, fitting, selection, prediction, or timing.

4.2 RQ1: App Detection and Components

Full App detects 105/126 modifications (83.3%). It produces no alarms on the 252 controlled normal records. Table 1 compresses the 14 configurations into five groups without dropping configurations: group membership requires matching complete outcome-count vectors across all six methods. Counts within a row are per original configuration, and the group-size column preserves the weighting. These are count equivalences, not claims of identical individual outputs across recipes.

The resource modification accounts for the nine detections lost by Web-only and by removing the memory reference: both fall to 96/126. The small tree detects 72/126. Its additional misses include the tested timezone and plugin/MIME modifications as well as resource and screen modifications. This comparison identifies the behavior of the fixed representation and capacity; it does not show that rules generally outperform learned classifiers.

All methods miss the nine webdriver-only and nine WebGL-identifier modifications. In the current historical-data-compatible pool, raw WebGL unavailability and loss of the original webdriver-false semantics prevent corresponding candidates from meeting assessability requirements. The result is a coverage limit of the admitted representation, not proof that these modifications are intrinsically undetectable.

Removing the MTC alarm cap increases screen detections from six to nine and the total to 108/126. Removing the timezone reference leaves the total at 105/126 because an absolute offset condition substitutes on this benchmark. Neither observation is enough to choose a method: the first requires inspecting normal-record costs, and the second requires normal-setting changes.

4.3 RQ2: The Cost of Removing Normal Constraints

Table 2 shows why the extra three detections do not justify the cap-free variant. With the cap, model configurations 01/02 generate one alarm in each historical evaluation cohort; configuration 03 generates none. Removing the cap alarms on all 144 and all 117 records for every configuration. Both methods still generate 0/252 alarms in the controlled benchmark, so that normal set alone does not expose the failure.

The cap-free models can select broad conditions such as hardware concurrency greater than one or a language-list length greater than one. These happen to respect the controlled-normal allowance while being common on the MTC records. The failure therefore concerns the support of the normal distribution, not only a different threshold along a well-calibrated tradeoff curve. The 630 training records tell the same story: with the cap, alarms are 6/6/0 and unknowns are 51 in each configuration; without it, all 630 alarm.

Low alarm counts must also be read alongside unknowns. Full App has 8/144 and 6/117 unknown outcomes, or 14/261 within each configuration. Removing its memory reference reduces the combined unknown count to 1/261 but loses resource detections.

Table 1: App-side detection and component comparisons. Cells give detections out of nine effective modifications per original configuration; parentheses give differences from Full App. Fourteen configurations are grouped only when their complete six-method state-count vectors agree. Adjacent equal results are merged. Group sizes retain the original weighting.

Modification group	Group size	Full App	No MTC alarm cap	App Web only	No memory relation	No timezone relation	App tree
CPU + memory	1	9		0 (−9)		9	0 (−9)
Screen metrics	1	6	9 (+3)	6			0 (−6)
Timezone; plugins/MIME	2	9					0 (−9)
Shared detections†	8	9 (all detected)					
Webdriver; WebGL IDs	2	0 (all missed)					
Total detections	14	105/126	108/126	96/126	96/126	105/126	72/126

Gray, green and red indicate equal, more and fewer detections than Full App, respectively; colors do not rank overall method quality. †Playwright, Puppeteer, CDP multi-field and Stealth presets; platform, UA, UA + platform and language-list modifications. All methods have 0/252 controlled-normal alarms; unknown, failed and empty-model counts are zero. Rules use saved RETENTION results and the tree uses FITTED results. The extra three screen detections without the cap have a separate normal-record cost (Table 2).

Table 2: Normal-record outcomes with and without the MTC alarm cap. Removing the cap makes every record in both historical evaluation cohorts trigger an alarm, while controlled detections increase only from 105/126 to 108/126. Both methods still have 0/252 controlled-normal alarms. Counts are records, with unknown outcomes reported separately.

Historical cohort	Model configuration	With cap (Full App)			Without cap		
		Alarm	No alarm	Unknown	Alarm	No alarm	Unknown
Evaluation (N = 144)	01/02	**1**	135	8	**144**	0	0
	03	**0**	136	8			
Reserved (N = 117)	01/02	**1**	110	6	**117**	0	0
	03	**0**	111	6			

Equal counts are merged for display; each configuration uses the same records, so denominators are not pooled. Failed and empty-model counts are zero. The separate 630 constraint-training records yield 6/6/0 alarms and 51 unknowns per capped configuration (01/02/03), versus 630 alarms and no unknowns without the cap. These historical cohorts are not a new blind evaluation.

The small tree gives binary outputs even when unused candidate measurements are missing; that behavior does not recover those measurements. We thus report decision coverage as part of the result, rather than equating no recorded alarm with usable normal evidence.

4.4 RQ3: What Device References Change

Table 3 compares *fixed individual checks*, not complete-detector ablations. The three studies answer different questions and retain separate denominators.

Memory. The device-referenced bound detects all 18 effective memory modifications, while the Web-only > 8 GiB check detects six. The additional 12 are the tested upward changes to 4 and 8 GiB; both conditions detect the six changes to 16 GiB. Both have 0/48 normal alarms. Six operations targeting 2 GiB have no observable effect and are excluded from the effective-modification denominator; neither check alarms on them. These results support the local value of a device-dependent bound, without showing sensitivity to downward, within-envelope, or coordinated changes.

Timezone: distinguish system changes from report changes. Both the Native-reference check and the absolute-offset check detect all six tested Web timezone modifications. Their normal alarms differ: zero versus six out of 30. The six alarms come from legitimate system changes. This explains why an unchanged aggregate score after removing the timezone relation does not imply that the relation is redundant. In the full-model replay, the no-timezone and Web-only ablations also alarm on those six normal changes, whereas FULL APP does not.

Screen geometry: retain detection without a layout shortcut. The fixed Web-height threshold detects six modifications but also alarms on six of 66 normal records. A same-Web viewport relation gives no normal alarms but misses all six modifications. The host bound detects all six with 0/66 normal alarms, distinguishing the tested layout expansion from the tested report modification. This is a standalone result: FULL APP configurations 01/02 still select the older height condition and alarm on those six normal layout changes; configuration 03 detects neither the changes nor the six modifications. We do not substitute the new condition's result for an unmeasured integrated-detector improvement.

4.5 RQ4: Where the External Browser Helps

On the 60 paired positions, FULL APP detects the two App timezone modifications, but neither App language modification nor any Browser modification. Adding the retained C1 relation detects all five Browser timezone modifications, yielding 7/14 instead of 2/14

Table 3: Specialist comparisons of fixed checks. Device-reference conditions (*) supplement detection or tolerate normal changes in these separate cohorts. Entries are detection and normal-alarm counts; the denominators appear once per group. These are individual checks, not complete-model ablations.

Specialist cohort	Fixed condition	Detected	Normal alarms
Memory 18 modifications; 48 normal	Web memory > 8 GiB	6	0
	System-memory upper bound*	18	0
Timezone 6 modifications; 30 normal	Absolute timezone offset	6	6
	System-timezone reference*	6	0
Screen 6 modifications; 66 normal	Fixed Web-height threshold	6	6
	Same-Web viewport relation	0	0
	Host-geometry upper bound*	6	0

Six memory operations with no observable effect produce no alarms and are excluded from the 18 effective modifications. Normal timezone changes (6) and layout changes (6) are subsets of their 30 and 66 normal records. Unknown and failed counts are zero. The host-geometry check remains a standalone specialist condition; it is not integrated into Full App.

Table 4: Increment from the retained cross-endpoint timezone check C1. All five additional detections are Browser timezone modifications; App timezone detection is preserved and both language families remain undetected. Bold marks changed counts, not statistical significance.

Method	App modifications		Browser modifications		Total detected	Normal alarms
	Timezone	Language	Timezone	Language		
Full App	2/2	0/2	0/5	0/5	2/14	0/46
Full App + C1	2/2	0/2	**5/5**	0/5	**7/14**	0/46
Count difference	0	0	**+5**	0	**+5**	0

These 60 paired positions have development-use history (14 effective modifications, 46 normal); unknown and failed counts are zero. Counts agree across three frozen configurations and are shown once, without pooling or claiming equal record-level outputs. On the separate historical MTC cohorts (144 and 117 records), alarms are unchanged within each configuration while combined unknowns increase from 14 to 17 out of 261.

(Table 4). The five new detections belong to one family and one endpoint. The two App-language and five Browser-language modifications remain undetected; C1 is not a general cross-endpoint manipulation detector.

Both methods have 0/46 normal alarms in this cohort, and the displayed counts agree across the three frozen configurations. They are displayed once, not summed to 21/42 detections or treated as independent replications. Historical normal evaluation supplies a further cost: within each configuration, adding C1 preserves the alarm count but increases unknowns from 14 to 17 out of the same combined 261 records. The two original historical groups remain distinct in the saved data. This targeted gain consequently neither proves complete evidence coverage nor demonstrates a universal zero-alarm rate.

5 Discussion, Limitations, and Ethics

What the evidence establishes. Cross-layer references can add information that selected single-field checks lack, and can also explain why an ordinary setting change should not alarm. Their value is conditional on available, correctly interpreted measurements. The strongest conclusion is therefore about specific mechanisms and their tradeoffs. The observations do not establish an independently trusted layer or a theoretical guarantee of detecting inconsistent manipulation.

Generality and attribution. The controlled benchmark covers three emulator environments and a finite set of recipes. Its repeated stages and development exposure limit independence. MTC normal records broaden the observed settings but do not supply attacks on an independent sample of physical devices. They are not clean-device attestations, and their historical split names do not erase development exposure. An ablation retrains the remaining pool, so its difference measures the behavior of that entire constrained alternative; it is not a causal estimate for arbitrary devices. The tree comparison controls representation and capacity but is not a comparison with tuned modern classifiers. No adaptive adversarial optimization or calibrated operational risk assessment is evaluated.

Missingness, drift, and integration. Unknown output is an operational cost, not a successful rejection or a harmless missing column. Adding a reference can turn a definite no-alert result into unknown, as seen with C1. Changes in WebView providers, API exposure, locale conventions, or device coverage may invalidate admissibility assumptions. The geometry check needs integrated selection and real-device validation, including window modes, keyboard interaction, and padding cases. C1 has no timestamp gate: collection-time differences can be benign, so its observed 0/46 normal alarms do not establish general robustness to asynchronous setting changes. Neither all 177 App fields nor all 244 paired fields have demonstrated marginal utility.

Privacy and responsible use. Collecting more device information to assess integrity can itself enable tracking. WebView tracking research and W3C guidance make that cost explicit [12, 13]. The reported manipulations concern controlled emulator environments; historical normals come from a cloud-device collection process. Its documented App permission scope is network access and network-state observation, without requesting contacts, SMS, photos, location, camera, or microphone access. This bounds that collection request, not all possible privacy implications of the fingerprint.

The draft artifact provides derived counts, condition definitions, and table sources; it does not bundle raw device payloads, pair tickets, or persistent identifiers. Institutional review or exemption and participant-consent approval are not established by the examined study artifacts, and we make no such claim. Those requirements and any raw-data release basis must be resolved through the applicable institutional process. A future deployment should minimize retained information and provide a fallback for unknown or conflicting evidence; these results do not justify automatic denial of service or authentication based solely on a fingerprint alert.

6 Related Work

Fingerprinting and authentication. Laperdrix et al. survey browser fingerprinting attributes, uses, and defenses [6]. Alaca and van Oorschot analyze device fingerprinting as an additional authentication signal [1], while Spooren et al. identify limitations of mobile fingerprints for risk-based authentication [8]. Cao et al. study cross-browser identification using OS- and hardware-level features [3]. These works motivate inspecting relationships among reports, but linking an identity across browsers is different from deciding whether a current observation violates a consistency condition. HybridGuard reports integrity evidence, not identity uniqueness or authentication success.

Spoofing and inconsistency analysis. Gummy Browsers demonstrates targeted browser spoofing [7]. Fp-Scanner examines inconsistencies introduced by fingerprinting countermeasures [10]; Him of Many Faces characterizes adversarial and benign fingerprints from commercial websites [14]. FP-Inconsistent studies spatial and temporal inconsistencies in evasive bot traffic [11]. BrowserFM represents dependencies among browser configurations and fingerprint features [5]. Thus inconsistency detection and structured fingerprint relationships are established ideas. Our novelty claim concerns the explicit formulation of cross-verification across Native, host, and in-app Web observations, with explicit missing states, constrained selection, and controlled normal-change comparisons. Different tasks, labels, inputs, and datasets prevent a meaningful numerical comparison of their published performance with our modification counts; we do not claim empirical superiority over these systems.

Android WebViews and boundary crossing. Tiwari et al.'s preprint examines Android WebView fingerprinting [9]. Tracking Without Borders studies WebViews' role in bridging mobile and Web tracking [13]. Cross-Boundary Mobile Tracking observes Java-to-JavaScript information diffusion in WebViews [4]. These studies show why an embedded Web runtime should be considered with its application context. Our question concerns whether complementary measurements expose controlled report modifications while tolerating ordinary changes. We evaluate host geometry separately and do not infer complete three-layer detector contributions merely from collecting all three surfaces.

7 Conclusion

HybridGuard studies fingerprint manipulation through complementary device observations, constrained rule selection, and explicit evidence states. On the saved controlled App benchmark, it detects 105/126 effective modifications with 0/252 controlled-normal alarms. Historical normals expose a severe cost hidden by the cap-free variant's three extra detections. Specialist checks show how references can recover memory modifications and tolerate tested normal changes; the paired extension contributes five Browser timezone detections. Shared WebGL/webdriver misses, language misses, unknown outcomes, and unintegrated host geometry remain material boundaries. The results support targeted reference checks with normal and missing-evidence accounting, while leaving independent generalization and operational deployment to further evaluation.

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A Configuration and Artifact Details

This appendix documents display compression and reproducibility details. The main text contains all results needed for its conclusions. The companion source package includes the four English table sources, their saved aggregate data, a source map, and a count-verification script. The script checks saved counts and compression; it does not rerun the detector or establish new experimental validity.

A.1 The Fourteen Configurations

Table 1 preserves five groups. The single-configuration groups are CPU plus memory and screen metrics. The two-configuration group with additional tree misses consists of timezone-only and plugin/MIME modifications.

The eight configurations detected by all methods are four legacy tool presets (Playwright, Puppeteer, CDP multi-field, and Stealth), platform-only, user-agent-only, user agent plus desktop platform, and the language-list preset. The common-miss group contains webdriver-only and WebGL-identifier modifications. A language-list modification here is not interchangeable with the App/browser language operations in Table 4. The companion aggregate-data mapping preserves the exact original recipe identifiers, suffixes, and source rows.

Group sizes are 1, 1, 2, 8, and 2. Multiplying each row's per-configuration detection count by its group size and summing gives 105, 108, 96, 96, 105, and 72 detections for the six methods. Each original configuration contributes nine effective modifications and 18 normal records. The compression tests the full count vector (N, T, F, U) together with failure and empty-model counts, not only the detection count. It preserves a mapping to every original configuration.

A.2 Frozen Models and Comparison Roles

The three App configurations hold out the API 29, API 30, and API 36 emulator environments, respectively. `APP_FULL` denotes the retained `B_REL_TZ` models; `A_NO_MTC_CAP`, `A_APP_WEB_ONLY`, `A_NO_MEMORY_REL`, and `A_NO_TIMEZONE_REL` denote retrained alternatives. `APP_TREE` is the candidate-state tree, and `PAIRED_BASE` is the frozen App detector plus C1. No cell substitutes a specialist condition or another model's best result.

The tree implementation uses scikit-learn 1.7.2, `splitter=best`, `random_state=20261006`, no class-weight override, and a positive-class probability threshold of 0.5. Its fold-specific inputs contain 63, 63, and 54 admitted atoms, each with three state indicators. These counts differ from the full expanded pool because training-side admission is applied. Fifteen positions per controlled held-out set and 73 of the 891 MTC records contain an unknown candidate; the saved decision paths do not use those missing atoms. A binary output is therefore not proof of complete observation.

A.3 Conditions, Unknowns, and Study Boundaries

The memory comparison uses the Native envelope and the fixed Web-memory threshold at 8 GiB. The absolute timezone comparator alerts above −480 minutes; the Native reference uses effective IANA offsets with fixed timezone data. The old screen comparator uses Web inner height greater than 710 CSS pixels. The host condition applies snapshot stability and the tolerance in Section 3; its measured result does not imply integration into the App model.

C1 requires both its field-status and field-quality markers to indicate an observed value. It accepts finite numeric offsets from the linked App Web and browser records, including zero and minus one, and alerts on inequality. Both offsets use the same Web sign convention. It has no timestamp acceptance gate. Pair integrity errors yield failure; absent, nonnumeric, nonfinite, or nonobserved operands yield unknown. The model's selected-input failure precedence and OR semantics still apply.

Across the two historical evaluation groups, Full App's per-configuration totals are $(T, F, U) = (2, 245, 14)$ for configurations 01/02 and $(0, 247, 14)$ for 03. With C1, they become $(2, 242, 17)$ and $(0, 244, 17)$, respectively. These are sums of the 144- and 117-record groups within one model, not additional records. The six no-effect memory operations remain outside effective-modification counts. Newer geometry engineering-smoke positions and later resource-extension experiments are outside the four selected materials and are not pooled into the manuscript results.

A.4 Training-Side Admission and Extension Selection

Numeric threshold expansion uses training-only quantiles at 0.25, 0.5, and 0.75. Candidate support requires at least three complete true/false triplets and at least two triggered modification triplets in at least one bundle/environment, in addition to the normal assessability criteria. These thresholds and the normal budgets are fixed before scoring; historical evaluation records do not supply threshold quantiles.

The browser-extension comparison enumerates four subsets: no addition, C1, C2, and C1 plus C2. Feasible sets are ranked by the equal mean of detection ratios for App timezone, App language, Browser timezone, and Browser language modifications, then by fewer additions and a fixed set order. This is a constrained choice on development-used material. The accepted C1 model is not assembled by selecting a different condition for each evaluation family.